“Strong people don't show emotion.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Families, sports, the military, workplaces, and some churches praise those who “keep it together.” Boys especially hear “Don’t cry.” We learn to bottle feelings, which then leak out as anger, numbness, or physical tension.

What Scripture teaches

“Jesus wept.” Isaiah calls Him “a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief.” Paul says, “Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep.” David wrote, “I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping.” Paul also says, “when I am weak, then I am strong.” The Lord who is strongest shows emotion. Strength is not the absence of feeling. It is facing feeling honestly and bringing it to God and to safe people.

> *“Jesus wept”* (John 11:35).

Also see

> “He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not” (Isaiah 53:3).

> “Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep” (Romans 12:15).

> “I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping and drench my couch with tears” (Psalm 6:6).

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me. That is why, for the sake of Christ, I delight in weaknesses, in insults, in hardships, in persecutions, in difficulties. For when I am weak, then I am strong” (2 Corinthians 12:9–10).

Common self-statements

- Tears are weakness.
- I have to hold it together.
- Feelings get in the way.
- I should not need anyone.
- Showing emotion makes me a burden.
- I will fall apart if I let it out.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either composed or weak.
- Mind reading: Assuming people would think less of me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling vulnerable and concluding that it is dangerous.
- Fortune telling: Predicting I will lose control.

Challenging questions

- Who taught me that feelings are weakness?
- How did Jesus show emotion?
- What happens to the feelings I hold in?

- Who is safe enough to share with?
- What would a friend say to someone who felt this way?
- What is one feeling I could name this week?

Truth summary

> Emotions are part of how God made me. Jesus wept, and strength includes honesty. I can name my feelings, bring them to God, and share them with safe people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Depression, Symptoms of
- Suffering
- Confession
- Weakness
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Strong people don't show emotion"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Strong people don't show emotion." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who taught me this?
- ☐ How did Jesus show emotion?
- ☐ What happens to held-in feelings?
- ☐ Who is safe?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What can I name?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus wept.
- ☐ The Savior was acquainted with grief.
- ☐ David poured out his tears to God.
- ☐ In weakness I am strong.
- ☐ Feelings are part of how God made me.
- ☐ Safe people can help me carry them.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ John 11:35
  "Jesus wept."
- ☐ Romans 12:15
  "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9–10
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me. That is why, for the sake of Christ, I delight in weaknesses, in insults, in hardships, in persecutions, in difficulties. For when I am weak, then I am strong."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Named feelings: Each day, name one feeling and tell God about it.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, John 11:35 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus wept, so my feelings are not weakness.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Suffering" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name what you feel. Write one feeling a day.
- ☐ Read the Psalms. Notice how David expresses emotion.
- ☐ Share with one person. Pick someone safe.
- ☐ Move or breathe. Release tension through a walk or slow breathing.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Strong people don't show emotion": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Named feelings
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Strong people don't show emotion.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, You wept. Teach me that strength includes honesty. Help me bring my feelings to You and to safe people. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #42 · MENTAL HEALTH AND SEEKING HELP

“Needing counseling means I have weak faith.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some were taught that prayer and Bible reading should be enough, and that anxiety or sadness shows a lack of trust. Seeking a counselor then feels like admitting spiritual failure. Many suffer for years before asking for help.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.” Scripture honors counsel: “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed,” and “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel.” Paul writes, “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.” God often heals through people. Asking for help is an act of wisdom and humility, and often of faith.

> *“Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed”* (Proverbs 15:22).

Also see

> “Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’” (Luke 5:31).

> “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel” (Proverbs 12:15).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).

Common self-statements

- If I trusted God more, I would not need help.
- Counseling is for people without faith.
- I should handle this through prayer alone.
- Going means I failed spiritually.
- People will think my faith is weak.
- God should be enough.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must choose either faith or counseling.
- Mind reading: Assuming others will judge my faith.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I have failed.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that counseling would not fit my faith.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that counseling means weak faith?
- Would I say that of someone who sees a doctor for an infection?
- What does Scripture say about seeking counsel?
- What has trying alone cost me?
- What would a Christian counselor offer?

- What is one step toward getting help?

Truth summary

> Seeking counsel is wise and consistent with faith. God works through prayer, Scripture, and also through trained, caring people. Asking for help is a step of courage, not weakness.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Wisdom
- Humility
- Pride
- Depression, Symptoms of

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Addictions

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Needing counseling means I have weak faith"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Needing counseling means I have weak faith." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn this?
- ☐ Would I say it of a doctor visit?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about counsel?
- ☐ What has trying alone cost?
- ☐ What could a counselor offer?
- ☐ What is my next step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The sick need a doctor.
- ☐ Plans succeed with many advisers.
- ☐ A wise man listens to counsel.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ God heals through people too.
- ☐ Asking for help is wisdom.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 15:22
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."
- ☐ Luke 5:31
  "Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ One step toward help: Each week, note one step you took toward support.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Proverbs 15:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Plans succeed with many advisers, so seeking counsel is wise.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Write the barrier. List what holds you back.
- ☐ Talk with someone. Share with a pastor or trusted friend.
- ☐ Find a counselor. Look for a licensed Christian counselor.
- ☐ Pray Proverbs 15:22. Ask God to guide you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Needing counseling means I have weak faith": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One step toward help
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Needing counseling means I have weak faith.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I thought needing help meant weak faith. Thank You for giving us counselors and friends. Give me courage to ask and wisdom to choose well. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #43 · MENTAL HEALTH AND SEEKING HELP

“If I just prayed more, I wouldn't feel this way.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Well-meaning people may say, “Just pray about it,” or “Give it to God,” leaving the suffering person feeling guilty. They pray more, feel no relief, and conclude that something is wrong with them or with their faith.

What Scripture teaches

Elijah, discouraged, prayed that he might die, and God did not rebuke him. He sent an angel who said, “Get up and eat,” and let him sleep. Paul prayed three times about his thorn, and God answered, “My grace is sufficient for you.” David prayed often and still wrote, “Why are you downcast, O my soul?” Prayer is vital, and it often brings peace. But God also gives rest, food, friends, doctors, and counselors. Continued pain is not proof of insufficient prayer.

> *“While he himself traveled on a day’s journey into the wilderness. He sat down under a broom tree and prayed that he might die. ‘I have had enough, LORD,’ he said. ‘Take my life, for I am no better than my fathers.’ Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, ‘Get up and eat.’”* (1 Kings 19:4–5).

Also see

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me. That is why, for the sake of Christ, I delight in weaknesses, in insults, in hardships, in persecutions, in difficulties. For when I am weak, then I am strong” (2 Corinthians 12:9–10).

> “Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him for the salvation of His presence” (Psalm 42:5).

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:6–7).

> “When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul” (Psalm 94:19).

Common self-statements

- If I had more faith, I would feel better.
- My prayers must not be good enough.
- Something is wrong with my relationship with God.
- I should not feel this way.
- God is withholding relief.
- I need to pray harder.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing prayer either removes feelings completely or has failed.
- Mind reading: Assuming God is displeased.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unrelieved and concluding that I prayed wrongly.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that nothing will help.

Challenging questions

- Who told me that prayer should remove these feelings?
- How did God care for Elijah when he was despairing?
- What other help might God have provided for me?
- What do I need besides prayer, such as rest, food, friends, or counsel?
- What did David do with feelings that persisted?
- What is one practical step I can add to prayer?

Truth summary

> Prayer matters, and so do rest, food, friends, and professional help. Persisting feelings do not prove failed faith. I can pray honestly and also care for myself and seek help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prayer, How to
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Tired
- Faith
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I just prayed more, I wouldn't feel this way"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I just prayed more, I wouldn't feel this way." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who said this?
- ☐ How did God care for Elijah?
- ☐ What other help might He give?
- ☐ What do I need besides prayer?
- ☐ What did David do?
- ☐ What can I add?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God cared for Elijah with rest and food.
- ☐ His grace is sufficient for me.
- ☐ David prayed and still felt downcast.
- ☐ Prayer and practical help work together.
- ☐ Feelings that persist are not proof of failed faith.
- ☐ I can ask for help.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

☐ 1 Kings 19:4–5

"While he himself traveled on a day's journey into the wilderness. He sat down under a broom tree and prayed that he might die. 'I have had enough, LORD,' he said. 'Take my life, for I am no better than my fathers.' Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, 'Get up and eat.'"

☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9–10

"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me. That is why, for the sake of Christ, I delight in weaknesses, in insults, in hardships, in persecutions, in difficulties. For when I am weak, then I am strong."

☐ Psalm 42:5

"Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him for the salvation of His presence."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Prayer and care: Each week, note one prayer and one practical step of care.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Kings 19:4–5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God cared for Elijah with rest and food, and He cares for me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Depression, Symptoms of" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Pray honestly. Tell God exactly how you feel.
- [ ] Meet basic needs. Sleep, eat, and move.
- [ ] Reach out. Tell a friend or counselor.
- [ ] Read 1 Kings 19. Notice how God cared for Elijah.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I just prayed more, I wouldn't feel this way": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Prayer and care
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I just prayed more, I wouldn't feel this way.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am weary and still struggling. Thank You for caring for me as You did Elijah. Help me pray honestly and receive the help You provide. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"People will think I'm crazy if they know."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Stigma about anxiety, depression, trauma, and other struggles teaches us to hide them. Early experiences of being dismissed, mocked, or whispered about confirm the fear. We pay for the secrecy with isolation.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture shows faithful people in great distress: "I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping." "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul." "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit." Paul writes, "Carry one another's burdens." "Two are better than one… if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" Sharing wisely with safe people brings relief. Not everyone will understand, but God does, and many will.

> *"When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul"* (Psalm 94:19).

Also see

> "I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping and drench my couch with tears" (Psalm 6:6).

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit" (Psalm 34:18).

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ" (Galatians 6:2).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Common self-statements

- They will see me as unstable.
- I have to keep it a secret.
- No one would understand.
- I will be treated differently.
- I will lose respect.
- I am the only one this happens to.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing others see me as either normal or crazy.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how people will react.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I am defective.
- Fortune telling: Predicting rejection.

Challenging questions

- Who has responded well when I have shared something hard?
- What exactly do I fear they will think?
- Who are the safest people to tell?
- How common are these struggles, even among believers?

- What does Scripture show about distress and God's nearness?
- What small piece could I share first?

Truth summary

> Struggling does not make me crazy. Many faithful people have suffered distress, and God is near. I can choose safe people, share at my own pace, and find relief and help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Depression, Symptoms of
- Anxiety/Worry
- Loneliness
- Confession
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People will think I'm crazy if they know"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People will think I'm crazy if they know." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has responded well?
- ☐ What do I fear?
- ☐ Who is safe?
- ☐ How common is this?
- ☐ What does Scripture show?
- ☐ What can I share first?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ His consolation delights my soul.
- ☐ Faithful people have wept and groaned.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ I can choose safe people.
- ☐ I can share at my own pace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 94:19
  "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Shared with a safe person: Each week, note one thing you shared and how it went.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 94:19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "When anxiety overwhelms me, God's consolation delights my soul.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List safe people. Write two or three trustworthy people.
- [ ] Share a small piece. Tell one person a bit.
- [ ] Read Psalm 6 and 94. Notice the honesty.
- [ ] Seek professional support. Talk with a counselor. If you ever think of harming yourself, call or text 988 (U.S.) right away.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People will think I'm crazy if they know": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Shared with a safe person
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People will think I'm crazy if they know.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear being judged. You are near to the brokenhearted. Give me safe people and the courage to share a little at a time. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #45 · MENTAL HEALTH AND SEEKING HELP

"I should be able to handle this on my own."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Self-reliance is praised, and asking for help can feel like failure. Some learned early that no one would help, so they learned to cope alone. Pride and fear of burdening others also play a part.

What Scripture teaches

God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone." "Two are better than one." Paul writes, "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ." "He who isolates himself pursues selfish desires; he rebels against all sound judgment." Jesus invites, "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." Even Jesus asked friends to watch with Him. We were made for interdependence. Needing help is not failure. It is how God designed us.

> *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ"* (Galatians 6:2).

Also see

> "The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'" (Genesis 2:18).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

> "He who isolates himself pursues selfish desires; he rebels against all sound judgment" (Proverbs 18:1).

> "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light" (Matthew 11:28–30).

Common self-statements

- I should be able to manage.
- Asking for help is weakness.
- I do not want to burden anyone.
- I have always handled things alone.
- If I need help, I have failed.
- No one will help anyway.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must be fully independent or a failure.
- Mind reading: Assuming I am a burden.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling that needing help is shameful.
- Fortune telling: Predicting no one will help.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn to handle things alone?

- Would I consider someone who asks for help weak?
- Who has helped me before, and how did they feel?
- What would I do if a friend were in my situation?
- What does Scripture say about bearing burdens together?
- What is one small request I could make this week?

Truth summary

> God made me for community. Needing help is part of being human, and receiving help blesses both sides. I can lean on God and on trusted people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Pride
- Friendship
- Humility
- Loneliness
- Weakness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I should be able to handle this on my own"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I should be able to handle this on my own." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn this?
- ☐ Is asking weak?
- ☐ Who has helped me?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What can I ask?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ It is not good to be alone.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ Jesus invites the weary to come.
- ☐ Receiving help blesses the giver.
- ☐ I can ask.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Matthew 11:28–30
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One request: Each week, note one time you asked for or accepted help.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 6:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "We carry one another's burdens, so I can ask for help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Humility" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Notice the pattern. Write how you handle things alone.
- [ ] Ask for one thing. Make a small request.
- [ ] Accept an offer. Say yes to help.
- [ ] Pray Matthew 11:28. Come to Jesus with your burden.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I should be able to handle this on my own": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One request
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I should be able to handle this on my own.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have carried this alone. Thank You for making us for each other. Help me ask, receive, and lean on You and on those You send. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.